

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

Toronto, Canada • +1 (416) 856-1276 • saber.ayatollahi@gmail.com • www.linkedin.com/in/sayatollahi

SUMMARY

Quantitative Advisor - Model Risk Management candidate with ~7 years across model governance, derivatives-pricing validation, and quantitative risk analytics. Operates within a formal model-governance framework at Moody's Analytics with delegated sign-off on valuation, sensitivity, and risk outputs, independently reviewing pricing models' conceptual soundness, curve calibration, and cross-asset behavior against SR 11-7-aligned standards. Python-fluent, with derivatives (rates, FX, inflation) and stochastic/Monte Carlo depth. CFA charterholder and dual MSc (Financial Modelling, Chemical Engineering).

CORE SKILLS

Model Risk Management (MRM) • SR 11-7-aligned governance • Pricing-model validation • Derivatives (rates, FX, inflation) • Independent review & challenge • Model documentation & certification • Python • R & MATLAB • Stochastic / Monte Carlo simulation • Stress testing & scenario analysis • Risk metrics & sensitivities • Curve construction & spread calibration • Cross-functional stakeholder engagement

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director - Modelling Services

Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Model Governance, Review & Certification

- Hold delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and risk outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios (\$5-25bn per engagement; \$50bn+ cumulative) - independently reviewing curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions prior to production release.
- Operate within a formal model-governance framework as a member of the model governance committee, reviewing methodology, benchmarking standards, assumption validity, and model-performance assessment consistent with SR 11-7-aligned expectations.
- Escalate outputs lacking mathematical or economic defensibility; serve as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues, interfacing with Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders.

Pricing-Model Validation & Risk Metrics

- Validate derivatives pricing models across rates, FX, and inflation - cross-checking sensitivity consistency and scenario impacts at portfolio-level risk aggregates.
- Review aggregation logic converting security-level exposures into portfolio-level risk metrics feeding downstream risk and capital processes.
- Oversee interest-rate risk and duration analysis under parallel and non-parallel rate shocks, reviewing conceptual soundness and accuracy of the underlying methodology.

Monitoring Methodology & Tooling

- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into scalable, auditable Python analytics pipelines with embedded logging, validation, and documentation controls.
- Built agentic-AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) automating code generation, validation scaffolding, and anomaly detection - reducing development cycle time by an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.
- Prepared analytical documentation and summaries for senior stakeholders on exposure, scenario impacts, and sensitivities, meeting internal governance and documentation standards.

Client Service Specialist

Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Served as technical liaison between institutional client investment teams and product/development functions - translating quantitative requirements into structured development requests and validating model outputs post-deployment.

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms across the PFaroe DB (risk & ALM) and PFaroe PM (portfolio management) platforms.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant - Financial Risk Transformation

Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 transformation projects for insurance clients, aligning regulatory requirements with system implementation and contributing to governance documentation and regulatory-readiness processes.
- Coordinated across actuarial, finance, IT, risk, and program-management functions on milestone delivery and implementation materials.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant - Asset-Liability Management & Risk

Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators for stress testing of interest-rate risk and funding volatility under base-case and stressed environments.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR using Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition, risk attribution, and near-optimal frontier robustness analysis.
- Performed cash flow, liquidity, and hedging analysis across interest-rate, inflation, and currency risk for international institutional clients; presented findings to investment committees.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016